

COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Acme Corp — Q2 FY2026

Competitive Intelligence & Innovation Watch

Field & Honey escalates on two fronts; the protein challengers and private label

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Primary aggressor	Field & Honey (Larksfield) — ~14% national share
The escalation	14g-protein line ext LCH00032, launched 2026-05-12
Second front	Field & Honey Almond (2025-09-08), Louisiana stealth
Private-label pressure	Great Value Honey Almond/Nut — 84–86% ACV at launch
Threat call	Larksfield now contests protein AND Louisiana simultaneously

Executive summary

The competitive picture in Q2 has a clear protagonist: Larksfield's Field & Honey brand. Already the national share leader among branded competitors (~14%) and the aggressor behind Crunchwell's Louisiana decline via its September 2025 Almond stealth launch, Field & Honey escalated on 2026-05-12 with a 14g-protein line extension (LCH00032) — a direct strike on ProteinPeak's one advantaged pocket. The move narrows ProteinPeak's protein delta from 11g to 6g while opening a second front in the Southeast. Behind Larksfield sit the usual protein/keto challengers (Magic Spoon, RXBAR, Catalina Crunch) driving high launch buzz but low velocity, General Mills extending Cheerios, and a high-ACV private-label wall.

- **Field & Honey is the aggressor:** Almond launch 2025-09-08 (LA-priority, took Crunchwell facings) and the 14g-protein line extension LCH00032 on 2026-05-12 (Southeast-priority) — two fronts, one competitor.
- **The protein escalation matters most:** LCH00032 pitches 14g protein against ProteinPeak's 12g, narrowing the delta to 6g. A trademark for a Field & Honey chocolate variant was filed 2026-04-22, signalling a likely Q4 chocolate launch.
- **Buzz vs velocity:** launch buzz is highest for the niche protein/keto DTC brands (Magic Spoon 0.92) but their in-market velocity is low; the real shelf threats are the high-ACV mass launches (Great Value 0.16–0.18 buzz but 84–86% ACV).
- **Cheerios stays busy:** Choco Crunch (2026-01-15) and Peanut Butter (2026-04-06) extend into Crunchwell's Family Sweet adjacency with national TV support.

1 · Field & Honey — the two-front aggressor

Launch date	Product	Price	Buzz d30	ACV %	Status
2025-09-08 00:00:00	Almond Crunch 14oz	\$4.39	0.78	32	Live
2026-03-30 00:00:00	Lemon Drizzle 14oz	\$4.39	0.36	N/A	Pre-Launch
2026-05-12 00:00:00	Protein 14g 12oz	\$4.79	0.84	23	Live

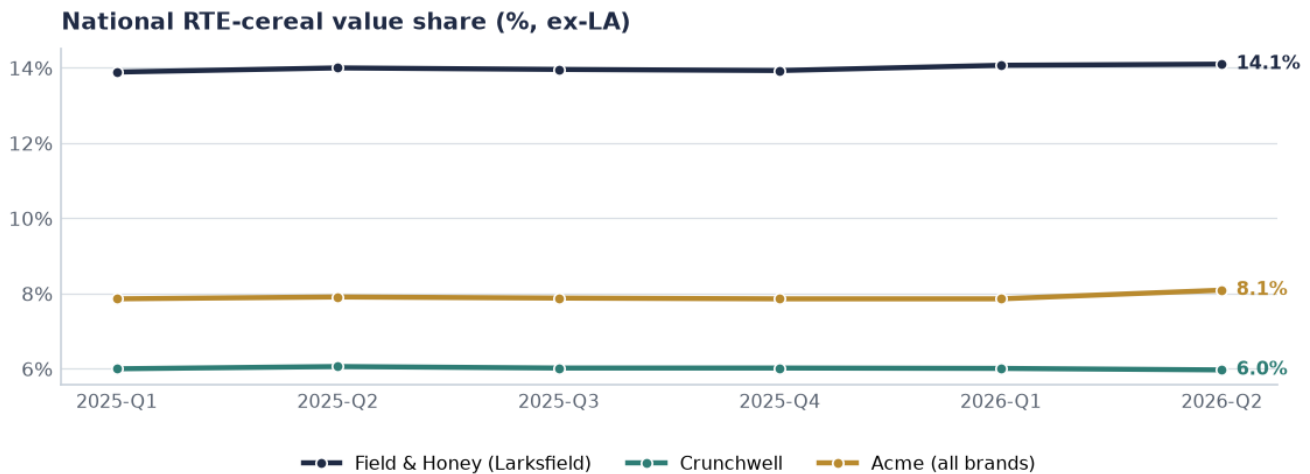
Source: seed_competitor_launches, brand = Field & Honey (Larksfield). ACV 'N/A' where pre-launch.

Field & Honey opened its Louisiana campaign quietly. The Almond Crunch launch on 2025-09-08 carried an explicit LA-DMA priority and 4-week endcap plus feature support; it is one of the five attributed causes of Crunchwell's Louisiana share decline (see Report 24). Then on 2026-05-12 Larksfield escalated with the Field & Honey Protein 14g line extension (LCH00032), flagged Southeast-priority and backed by a Walmart paid-sampling and influencer push. This is the strategically important move: it takes the fight into Wellness Protein, the one pocket where Acme has a defensible share position, while keeping pressure on Louisiana.

The protein delta just narrowed from 11g to 6g

ProteinPeak's competitive story leaned on a protein advantage. Field & Honey's 14g line extension narrows that delta to 6g versus ProteinPeak's 12g — the sugar leg still favours ProteinPeak (8g, low), but the headline protein claim is now contested. A trademark filing for 'Field & Honey Chocolate Crunch' on 2026-04-22 points to a Q4 chocolate launch that would directly counter ProteinPeak Cocoa Almond and the Chocolate Almond concept in test (Report 33).

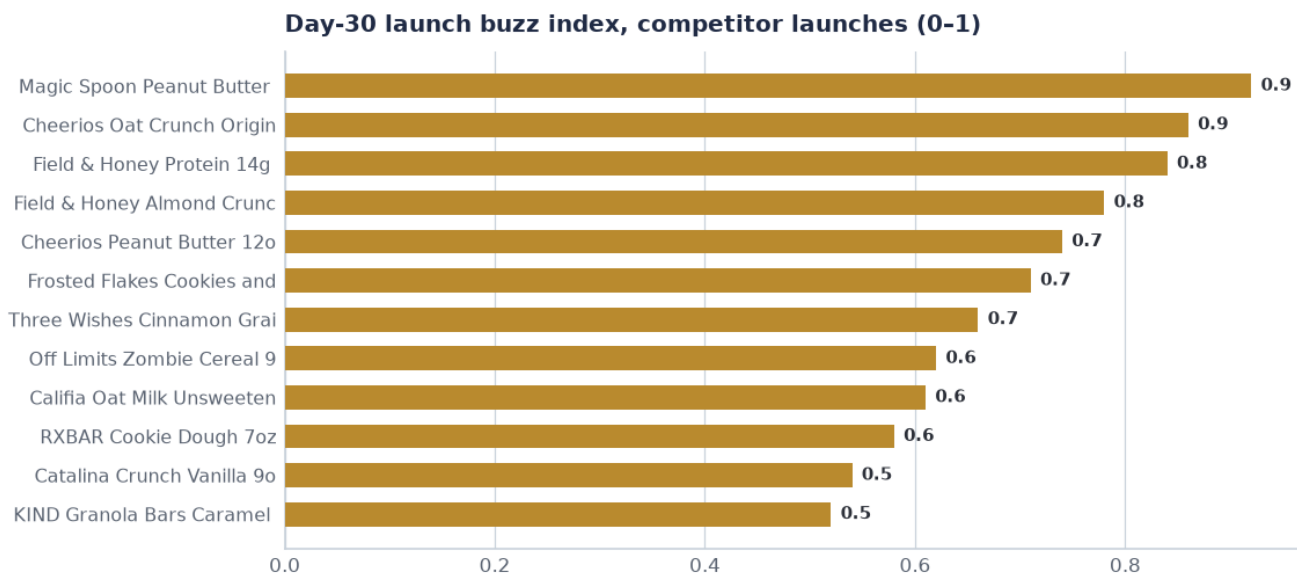
2 · National share — Larksfield leads, Crunchwell holds



Larksfield holds a ~14% national lead over Crunchwell's ~6%; both are broadly stable nationally.

Nationally, Field & Honey (Larksfield) holds ~14.1% value share against Crunchwell's ~6.0% and Acme all-brand ~7.9–8.1%. The national picture is stable — this is not a broad-based share war. The danger is regional and segment-specific: Larksfield is willing to spend aggressively in targeted DMAs (Louisiana) and is now extending into the protein pocket, so the national-share calm understates the pressure in the two places that matter to Acme's growth algorithm.

3 · Launch buzz vs shelf reality



Buzz peaks for niche protein/keto DTC launches; it does not equal shelf velocity or ACV.

Day-30 buzz is highest for the small protein/keto brands — Magic Spoon Peanut Butter (0.92), Off Limits (0.62), Three Wishes (0.66) — but their in-market velocity is a fraction of the mass launches, because buzz concentrates in narrow, highly-online audiences. The launches that actually move shelf are the high-ACV mass

entries: Great Value Honey Almond / Nut carry almost no buzz (0.16–0.18) but launched at 84–86% ACV and are among the highest-velocity new items, having absorbed Crunchwell's lost Walmart facings in the September 2025 reset. Read buzz and distribution together: buzz tells you where the cultural energy is, ACV tells you what is actually taking the shelf.

4 · The rest of the competitive field

4.1 · General Mills — Cheerios extensions

General Mills continues to extend Cheerios into Acme adjacencies with heavy national support. Choco Crunch (2026-01-15) and Peanut Butter (2026-04-06) both push into the Family Sweet / Family Oat space adjacent to Crunchwell, each backed by national TV plus endcap. Cheerios Oat Crunch (2026-01-15, buzz 0.86, 69% ACV by day 90) is a direct shelf-adjacency threat to Crunchwell Original Family.

4.2 · Protein / keto challengers

Magic Spoon, RXBAR, Catalina Crunch, Three Wishes and Off Limits crowd the Wellness Protein pocket from the premium DTC end (price points \$6.99–\$9.99). Individually they are low-ACV, low-velocity and creator-dependent, but collectively they establish the protein-cereal occasion that both ProteinPeak and now Field & Honey are scaling into mass distribution. They are the leading indicator, not the direct threat.

4.3 · Private label

Great Value (Walmart PL) Honey Almond and Honey Nut Toasted Oats launched August 2025 at \$2.79 and reached 84–86% ACV almost immediately inside Walmart's modular. They are a structural price-floor pressure and a documented contributor to Crunchwell's Louisiana facing loss. Whole Foods' 365 PL move (2025-09-22) was an explicit response to Field & Honey Almond — private label reacts to branded aggression fast.

Threat assessment & Acme response

Priority 1: Field & Honey's protein escalation (LCH00032) contests Acme's one growth engine — respond by holding the ProteinPeak sugar/taste story, defending the 12g claim, and pre-empting the likely Q4 chocolate launch with the Chocolate Almond concept (Report 33). Priority 2: continue the Louisiana recovery against Field & Honey Almond and Great Value (Report 24). Priority 3: monitor — the DTC protein challengers and Cheerios extensions are watch-items, not fire-drills.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Defend the ProteinPeak protein/sugar/taste claim against Field & Honey 14g; brief sales on the 6g-delta narrowing.	Sage Park / Competitive Intel	Q3 FY26
2	Accelerate the Chocolate Almond concept decision (Report 33) to pre-empt Larksfield's trademarked Q4 chocolate launch.	VP Innovation	Now
3	Sustain the Louisiana recovery vs Field & Honey Almond + Great Value (Report 24).	Marcus Boudreaux	Ongoing
4	Stand up a monthly protein-pocket competitive tracker now that mass players have entered (cross-ref Report 39).	Competitive Intelligence	Monthly